



THE PEARL FISHERS

This is the title page of a German edition of Bizet's first major opera, *The Pearl Fishers*, which tells the story of a love triangle set in a fishing village in ancient times.

Turbulent times

Bizet's personal life was in turmoil at this time. In 1862, he fathered an illegitimate child with the family's housekeeper, although this was hushed up (the mother only revealed the secret on her deathbed). Bizet later married Geneviève Halévy. Their union was sometimes rocky, largely due to the interference of Geneviève's mother, who was mentally unstable.

Meanwhile, his career was stalling. He was burdened with